YE OLDE STREETE OF PAVEMENTE, YORK.

BY MR WM. CAMIDGE.

CHAPTER XXII (continued).
LEGAL AND OTHER CUSTOMS.
(CONTINUED.)

Another custom arising partly out of fact and partly out of fiction was observed in this city; the ground of the custom was laid in a statement that in the third year of the reign of William the Conqueror, he laid seige to the City of York, which although once taken, continued up to this time unsubdued. The Conqueror finding he could not secure an absolute conquest either by strategy or strength, ultimately raised the siege and abandoned the hope of securing the city for a little while. One day he accidentally met two friars belonging to St. Peter's, afterwards St. Leonard's Hospital, at the village of Skelton, three miles away from the city. They were on a begging excursion, seeking provisions to make Christmas festive; they had been so successful that their wallets were full, and in addition one of them carried in his hand a shoulder of mutton, whilst two cakes hung from his neck, and the other Friar carried several bottles of ale, hung from his neck by strings. The King, having learnt something of their poverty, tempted them with a bribe, and promises of future help, if they would let him, and his soldiers into the city at a time appointed, so that he might subdue it. After some bargaining the Friars accepted the offer, and agreeably to their arrangement the Conqueror sent for his soldiers, and at the given time they presented themselves, and were admitted into the town by the Friars, by which means the Conqueror became the master of the City. As an evidence of his admiration of the courage of those who had defended the city he made Sir Robert Clifford a lord, with the title of Lord Clifford, whilst four inquisitions were made, viz. Hovingate, Talbot (who afterwards came to be Lord Talbot), Lassells, and Evingham, were knighted. It is said that the arms of the city at this time were argent, a cross gules, *i.e., St. George's Cross*, but the Conqueror, to mark his sense of the valour displayed by the five captains who defended the city, charged the cross with five lions passant gardant *Or*, and made Sir Robert Clifford governor of the city. His Majesty, according to the legend, offered to the newly-appointed officers the privilege of taking any four more knights of their tribe, and in their abhorrence of the treachery which the Friars had exhibited, they asked for, and obtained leave to have a procession for ever in the city, which procession, with a proclamation, was made at a ceremonious place, annually on Day for many generations succeeding. It was the custom to have a man dressed up as a Friar, with his face painted as a Jew, and place him on horseback to ride through the city; instead of a bridle he held in one hand a rope, and in the other a shoulder of mutton, whilst one cake was hung on his back, and another on his breast. A vast concourse of people followed him as he passed through the streets, making discordant noises, and especially shouting out "Youl youl." The custom was continued to prove a lasting the betrayal of the city until within the last two centuries, when it was abandoned, in all probability, because of the riot and excesses it engendered.

Other customs having a less legal significance were also carried out in this street from time to time. When the plague visited York in 1631, active measures were devised to stay its progress, and amongst other things a set of rules or orders were posted in Pavement for the information of the people, which rules were to be observed during the continuance of the scourge.

ORDERS.

1. "When sickness of any kind soever appears in any house, the Lord Mayor to be informed, and none to go into, or out of such house until he gave direction.

2. None to disperse their families or remove any member of their household without licence of the Lord Mayor, and none to receive such persons so removed. If any disobey, their houses set up and shut up."

"Precepts prescribed by learned and approved physicians."

1. "Let those poor people who are afraid to be infected by being employed about the sick eat butter and bread with sage, rosemary, parsley pilled in the morning before their employment.

2. Let them put into their drink ginger sliced, and steep it in the tops of wormwood, first washed and burnt.

3. Let them put in their mouths lethwell, or angelico, for want of it, or gentian.

4. Let them tie upon a stick, posie wise, a little piece of sponge, well dipped in white wine vinegar camphorated, which they may have at the apothecaries.

5. Let the infected house be perfumed with the perfume of tar, pitch, or resin, or juniper wood, and also all their clothes; also let them perfume their houses with vinegar or rosemary, or bay leaves.

6. If any botches or plague sores arise, let them use either of these medicines to draw them to a head and to ripen and burst them, viz. :—Take the roots of white lillies, roast them well in a good quantity of sorrell lapped in a wet paper; then stamp them, and apply them hot to the swelling, and let it lie on 24 hours, twenty-four hours, or apply fresh if need be. But be sure to burn the plasters so taken off in the chimney fire. Or this: Take a quantity of leaven, a handful of mallows, of sorrell as much, of sassafras root, of liquorice, let these pilled and sliced, let all these be boiled in old style, until they come to a soft pultis, stamp it, and apply it hot to the place thick spread, and this renew every twelve hours, burning it after it is taken off, as before said. They may drink (if they can yet) whigg and buttermilk, but not way. All the above directions serve as well (or more proper) for the infected as for those who are not."

Another class of exhibitions in this street, although not strictly constitutional, were those of what of that character—they were expressions of public opinion and connected with Royalty. During the reign of James much dissatisfaction and unhappiness was engendered as a consequence of his Majesty's effort to restore the Catholic religion, and the citizens of York, inspired somewhat by the heads of leading county families, displayed considerable opposition to the King's action. A county meeting was called for the 20th November, 1688, and assembled in the Guildhall, where strong language was used, and much excitement was called forth, ending in the crowd rushing into the streets, damaging the property of Roman Catholics, sacking their houses and their chapels, and ultimately carrying off a large quantity of books and vestments, and other articles of beauty and utility, which they carried in triumph into the Pavement, where they piled up their stolen treasure in heaps and set them on fire, dancing round the burning mass with every evidence of glee. During the day the crowd threw down the altars, destroyed all the pictures and statues, and committed every kind of indignity in the meeting houses of people who differed with them in religious sentiment. Another exhibition, which was more of a display of public temper than an ordinary custom, was once shown in this street towards the Protector (Oliver Cromwell), who was never a favourite with the citizens of York. During the Commonwealth the loyal citizens had suffered severely at his hands; many of the magistrates had been displaced, and other action had been taken which was particularly offensive to the people; therefore on the 29th of May succeeding the restoration the loyalty of the citizens was expressed in an emphatic manner. A general holiday was observed, before which two effigies had been prepared, one to represent Cromwell and the other Judge Bradshaw, who had distinguished himself by his injustice as a judge. The former was habited in a pink satin suit, adorned with ribbons, &c., the latter was habited in a judge's robe. The Scottish Covenant and the late state arms, which for some little time had been hung in the Guildhall, were taken down, and all were taken in an irregular procession to ye oulde streete of Pavemente, where a gallows had been erected to receive them, and upon which the effigies were hung for the greater part of the day. When evening arrived they were put into three tar barrels and set ablaze, along with the gallows, amid a great concourse of people, who entered heartily into the excitement which attended the exhibition. Fully one thousand citizens in the throng bore arms, so that they might give something of military authority to the doings of the crowd. Amid shouts and noise the fire [illegible], and it was not until the last flickering flame had died out that the people departed from the [illegible] of what had been to them a most memorable and great rejoicing.

The custom of burning meat which had been seized by the butchers' searchers, and condemned by the Lord Mayor, was carried out in ye olde street of Pavemente, until a little while before the opening of Parliament street. After the condemnation, the searchers purchased a tar barrel or two, and piled upon them, and about them, a quantity of shavings, and broken wood, then at a given hour in the evening, they placed on the combustible heap the condemned meat; sometimes the whole or greater part of a cow, sometimes a sheep, or a lamb, and they set the prepared mass on fire, much to the amusement of the gathered throng. The fire soon blazed merrily, and a good deal of merriment ensued, especially at the expense of the owner, whilst the younger part of the concourse indulged in coarse and dangerous practices. The burning was ruin to the owner of the meat seized, and was much more effective as a deterrent than any fine which could have been imposed even though it went to the funds of the company. In late years the burning of bad meat was transferred to Thursday Market, and on the last occasion of such penalty a person living in Church-street, who always kept a number of dogs, attended the scene, and, watching his opportunity, seized a piece of burning mutton with a hayfork, and ran away with it to serve his dogs. The scence of hilarity and confusion which occurred then, and the threatened proceedings which followed the city authorities to determine that in future those noisy scenes, with all their unseemly and disorderly proceedings, should be abandoned.

(To be continued).

DEATH OF MR. LANCELOT FOSTER, YORK.

The interment of a very old and much respected citizen, in the person of Mr Lancelot Foster, father of the gentleman who has so ably filled the office of City Sheriff during the past year, took place at the cemetery on Tuesday afternoon. His death occurred shortly after midnight on Saturday, at his house in St. Saviourgate, Mr Foster having attained the ripe age of 86 years, for many years he had been in failing health. He leaves a daughter (Mrs Wilkinson, of Thirsk), and two sons (Mr H. M. Foster, and Mr Councillor L. Foster). Deceased, who was born on December 14, 1806, began business on Foss Bridge, in 1827, as a grocer and seedsman, having served an apprenticeship with the late Mr John Jackson, of Church-street. His purchases of premises began in the year 1840 Lyth, and traded in Walmgate up to a comparatively short time ago, when he disposed of the concern to Messrs Pulliser Bros. In 1843 he was appointed one of the coroners for the Walmgate district, and held that office until 1886. The Merchants' Company had in him one of their oldest members, and several times he was appointed to the dignity of master. He was for a period of fifty years a feoffee of the church of St. Dennis, Walmgate, and although a strong Wesleyan, always manifested a warm interest in the parochial affairs of Holy Trinity, Goodramgate, and the pioneer of the Sunday School movement in York. His connection with Sabbath School work extended over half a century. As far back as 1822 he became a teacher at the Albion-street Chapel, afterwards the Priory-street Wesleyan Sunday School, in which he filled the office of teacher and superintendent for 55 years, and when he retired in 1877 he was presented with an illuminated address, which the officers and teachers of the school, signed on their behalf by Mr John Francis Taylor, who had been his colleague as a superintendent throughout all those years. Deceased was in politics a Liberal, but he was never a prominent party man.

The funeral rite was conducted by the Rev J. T. F. Halligey (chairman of the York Wesleyan District), assisted by the Rev J. W. Kendall. The gathering around the grave side was large and sympathetic. The chief mourners were Mr H. M. Foster and Mr Councillor Foster, the two surviving sons of the deceased, and Mrs Wilkinson, his daughter, as well as Miss Foster, daughter of Mr Councillor Foster; Mrs H. M. Foster, Master Foster, and Mr and Mrs Smith. The Merchants' Company was represented by Mr Councillor Procter (Governor), Mr Ald. Rooke (Deputy Governor), Ald. Sir Joseph Terry, Mr Councillor Gainforth, and Mr T. P. Bulmer (past Governors), Mr Hunt (Warden), Mr Canon Raine (Chaplain), Mr Joseph Wilkinson (Secretary), Mr W. W. Wilberforce, Mr Thomlinson-Walker, Mr W. B. Bellerby, and Mr Pape. There were also present Messrs J. Jarman, Cowling, Cowling, Cowling, Taylor, Wright, and Fawcett, Mr Councillor Proctor, Mr J. Bellerby, Mr George Dickenson, Mr William Monkhouse, Mr R. N. Melrose, Mr Bollans, Mr George Jackson, Mr C. Sellers, Mr Richard Hill, Mr Bowser, Mr Jno. Mennell (deputy registrar of marriages), Mr Jno. Cross, Mr Edwd. Hill (Micklegate), and others. The place selected for burial was a plot of ground at the lower side of the Cemetery, where lie the deceased's wife, Ann Davis Foster, and his son Francis. A large number of beautiful wreaths had been sent, the contributors including Mr Councillor Foster and Miss Foster, Ald. Sir Joseph Terry, Mr Councillor Gainforth, Mr C. Sellers, and Messrs L. Foster and Sons' employés. Subsequent to the obsequies the Merchants' Company met at the Guildhall, in Coney-street, and on the motion of the Governor, seconded by Ald. Sir Joseph Terry, passed the following resolution:—"That this Court desires to place on record its sincere regret at the unexpected decease of Mr Lancelot Foster, the oldest and one of the most esteemed and respected members of this Company, who held the office of Governor during the years 1856, 1857, 1858, 1859, 1870, and 1871, and who was admitted to his freedom so far back as the 16th of January, 1825, and this Court further desires to convey to his sons, Mr R. M. Foster and Mr Councillor Foster, and to the other members of the family, its heartfelt sympathy and condolence with them in their painful bereavement."

IN Auburn, Maine, population 10,000, there are only two policemen, one for the day and two for the night.

SPIRITS to the value of £1,000,000 sterling were shipped in the vessels bound for South and West Africa during 1891, and a single port, last year, in the course of a single week.

THE trade prices for gin on the West Coast of Africa is twopence-halfpenny a bottle; while rum can be bought at 4s. 6d. per dozen bottles, and gin at 4s. 6d.

FOR wilfully destroying cushions and curtains in a second-class carriage on the South-Western Railway between Clapham Junction and Vauxhall, Arthur James Langford, a young man, has been committed for twelve months' hard labour by Mr De Rutzen at Southwark.

Two great Corsican families, the most powerful in the island, the Gavinis and the Casabiancas, have just been reconciled after a political hostility of more than 30 years.

SERIOUS EXPLOSION OF A TOY CANNON.—On Monday night a large toy cannon burst among several people who were firing it beside a bonfire at Dudley. Two persons were seriously injured, one of whom, a miner named Jonas Long, was not expected to recover. Long, who is married, was terribly cut about the head; Ebenezer Bateman was blinded, Joseph Cooper was cut and bruised, and a youth was cut about the forehead.

SOME gipsies left a male infant in a barn and decamped. The farmer and his wife wondered however the child could have got there. "Look here," said the wife to her husband, "if it an omen of no rear anyhow. When he has grown bit, and learnt to talk, he'll tell us where he came from."

A SPONTANEOUS production is against matter of fact; a thing without example, not only in man, but the vilest of weeds.—BENTLEY.

CHEESE.—G. BRITTON has received his usual large supply for the season of FINE RIPE CHEESE, consisting of the best Cheddar, Cheshire, Stilton, Gorgonzola, Parmesan, Derby, and American—direct from the most famous farms. Quality, condition, and price unsurpassable.—G. Britton, Clifton House, Bootham. Branches—56, Petergate, and 95, Micklegate, York.

THE RAILWAY DISASTER NEAR THIRSK.

RAISING THE ENGINE.

Sunday was a day fraught with painful interest and expectancy over the scene of the terrible railway disaster near Thirsk on November 2nd. It was then that the duty was undertaken of lifting the wrecked engine and tender from the position they had occupied since the fatal morning of the catastrophe. A crowd, which numbered nearly a thousand, eagerly fixed their gaze upon the spot which the tender had vacated, under the impression that some evidence of human remains might be discovered. There was nothing, however, but charred wood and cinders. Next the engine was denuded of its great wheels, and then the united power of two steam cranes were devoted to raising the bulk of nearly 40 tons of iron. The engine was first slowly dragged a couple of yards, and once more the anxious throng advanced in expectation of discoveries. There was, however, nothing to be seen, save half-burnt water. A quick inspection at once set at rest any question of the presence of other bodies; there was not a trace of human remains. A staff of two hundred workmen were engaged in dragging away the debris and raising the engine and tender, the latter being laid on its side half way into a field on the east of the line, whilst the engine, which is stated to have been in two pieces, was laid within about 50 yards of the Manor House cabin. To prove the force of the collision, we may mention that the skeleton of the tender was completely bent, and for a day or two after the engine was lying there was burning in the tender. The Pullman car had its fore portion smashed in, and was broken up, it being found impossible to remove it. The engine boiler could be seen, and Mr Wilson Worsdell, chief engineer, directed the work, and other North Eastern railway officials present were Mr Graham, district engineer, of Darlington, and his assistant, Mr Murray; the traffic superintendents, Messrs Carr and Batey, locomotive superintendents; Mr Noble, of the traffic department; and Mr Harper, stationmaster at York. Operations were begun soon after daybreak, and continued until the removal of the wreckage, the engine, or what remained of it, being deposited upon a bogey, which, having been attached to a train, was conveyed to the company's engine shops at Darlington.

One of the York labourers engaged, named William Wilson, had his left hand badly crushed, and he was sent to the Thirsk Hospital, while another labourer had his head cut.

WHAT THE WRECKAGE DISCLOSED.

During the careful search which followed, the remaining *debris* and the heaps of ashes and cinders disclosed many painful evidences of the calamity. A silver watch had been found on Saturday, and now two more were recovered, all of them being irreparably damaged. One of them belonged to Captain Duncan McLeod, who was amongst the killed. It was at once identified as his property by means of the following inscription, evidently done with a knife:—"D. A. McLeod, 42nd, Cairo, Kassassin, Ashtab, Tel el Kebir, Suakim, Tofrek, Haindal, Berti, and Kerbekan," this apparently being a record of engagements in which the gallant officer had taken a part. There was also found a Khedive's medal of Egypt, with clasps, a silver medal with clasps bearing the names Kerbekan, the Nile, 1890, and El Teb. Round the rim of the medal was inscribed the name of "Lieutenant D. McLeod, 42nd Highlanders." These mementoes, it is supposed, were in Captain McLeod's travelling bag at the time of the accident, along with the watch. All three articles bear signs of having been in close contact with fire. They were taken possession of by Mr Harper, the York stationmaster, who undertook to forward them to the deceased's father, General Sir J. McLeod. Another of the watches found was thought to belong to the goods train guard, George Petch, who lost his life. Among other articles found were a pair of scissors, a pearl-hafted knife (damaged by fire), a shoulder pin set in gold, a brooch of gold-based metal, supposed to be gold, silver, and copper coinage; two pieces of cloth, presumed to be part of two ladies' jackets, the goods guard's sou-wester hat, and the remains of the guard himself. Nothing was discovered which, so far as is known, suggested any trace of the two missing ladies, Miss Mary Jolliosh and Miss Mackenzie. In connection with the disaster a valuable parcel, which was in the ill-fated train in the first guards' van, and was in transit between Edinburgh and London, is missing.

FUNERAL OBSEQUIES.

On Saturday the body of Captain McLeod, 1st Black Watch, was interred at Stirling. The funeral was of a private character, none but the relatives and some immediate friends being present. Among the many messages received were telegrams from members of the Royal Family.

The remains of the late Mr John Boswell Hill were interred at Selby, on Saturday afternoon, the funeral being attended by a considerable company of legal gentlemen and others.

The burial of Mr J. H. Lee, one of the victims, took place on Saturday afternoon. A special funeral service was held at half-past twelve in the Parish Church, Spitalfields, London, of which the deceased was a churchwarden. The service was attended by upwards of 200 mourners, and nearly all the shops in Spitalfields market were closed in respect for his memory, he having been one of the prominent salesmen in the market. The interment took place in the Victoria Park cemetery.

On Sunday afternoon the remains of the goods guard, George Petch, who was killed in the catastrophe, were interred in the New Cemetery, Linthorpe, Middlesbrough. The corpse of the deceased's lodgings in Carey-street shortly before three o'clock, and despite an exceedingly wet afternoon upwards of 230 railway men and others joined the procession. The hearse was drawn by two conducted by the Rev C. E. Stone, in the Baptist Chapel.

Several wreaths have been placed on the grave of little Lottie Hamilton, who was laid in her last resting place in Thirsk Cemetery, and the children attending the Church Schools in Thirsk, under the supervision of the Rev George Gill, are subscribing for a tombstone to her memory.

PREACHERS NOT YET FREE FROM CALAMITY.

There were various pulpit references to the calamity on Sunday. The Vicar of Thirsk, though absent from home on account of ill-health, forwarded a deeply sympathetic letter.

The Curate, the Rev. Ernest Richardson, preached at the Parish Church in the morning, his text being Daniel iii., 2. He said, in the course of his sermon: I feel sure your hearts have ached, as mine has, as has heartbroken Thirsk and Sowerby had itself. That anyone escaped to tell the story at all appears little short of miraculous. I need scarcely say how we as a town mourn with those who have lost some dear relative or friend, with the poor old Laird and his lady, who have lost their boy, to whom but a few hours before they had bidden a tearful farewell; with the injured Mr Wilson Worsdell, who lost his sister, whose niece now lies in our cemetery, to keep us in continual memory of the dire catastrophe. Poor little Lottie Hamilton! To be thus cut off in childhood's way to manhood's prime, she nursed her tiny doll. We can mourn, too, with poor Mackenzie, who has lost the desire of his eyes at a stroke; and with the wife of the noble engine driver, who lost her husband, the noble men—who, though lying with a fractured thigh, had the courage, when assistance came to him, to say "attend to the passengers first." I cannot tell you how grateful to Her Most Gracious Majesty for the kind sympathy she has expressed to the injured survivors. She is indeed a mother to her people, and happy is that nation which has such a ruler. Having lived in this neighbourhood, and have known many of the men employed on the North-Eastern Railway Company intimately. Without exception, they are worthy, reliable men, men whom you would be proud to have in your life to, for that is what it amounts to when you are travelling. Some of them assist in our choir, some in our Sunday School, others attend our services, for these are not people who neglect religion.

At evening the Rev George Gill was the preacher. He said: Every heart in this town and neighbourhood has been touched with tenderest sorrow for those who have lost dear relatives, and are still suffering, or are mourning the loss of their loved ones. To-day our devout prayers are offered to Almighty God that they will soon be restored to health and strength again.

Preaching at Sowerby Parish Church, the Rev E. S. de Courcy Ireland said: This year has been a year of calamities, visitations, and sorrows. God must mean something by them. There is a voice in them to which we should listen. Great men have been removed from our midst, men who could be little spared, and whose places will be hard to fill. The scourge of cholera has visited our land, and has swept away thousands upon thousands of lives, while starting shipwrecks and other calamities have been of frequent occurrence. Are not all these things calculated to make us pause and think?

At Salem Congregational Church, Sunday was fixed for the harvest festival, and the preacher was the Rev C. E. Darwent, of Hull. Before commencing his sermon he desired to give public expression of their sorrow at the great and terrible disaster that had happened in the neighbourhood of Thirsk, and had spread the name of the town over the whole of the civilised world. They felt that while it was their harvest thanksgiving Sunday, their feelings of thankfulness and joy should be chastened by sorrow at the sad event. They had the very deepest sympathy with those whose friends had been carried away by a sudden—and, in the case of those who were killed, a terrible most lamentable death. None could come together without feeling there was a dark shade cast over their service.

At the Primitive Methodist Chapel the Rev J. Laverick, circuit minister, who had visited some of the suffering ones, made special reference to the disaster, and expressed the deepest sympathy.

THE INJURED PASSENGERS.

Mr A. Mackenzie, of Edinburgh, and Mr D. McCulloch, of Alexandria, Dumbartonshire, had on Sunday sufficiently recovered to allow of their removal home. Mr A. Buchanan, who was on his way from Edinburgh to Sowerby Bridge, was a patient along with Ewart, the driver of the express, in Thirsk Cottage Hospital. The reports concerning him have been favourable, and early in the week it was anticipated that in about a fortnight he would be in a fit condition to leave the institution. He has had the company of the Rev R. Buchanan, of Clyde Bank, his brother.

Ewart's one proved a very serious one, and for some time the unfortunate man's life appeared to hang in the balance. He was the recipient of a kindly sympathetic letter from Mrs Grimmett, of Greenholme, Princess Avenue, Hull, who expressed her admiration of his manly courage under intense suffering immediately after the accident, in calling upon his rescuers to mind others before himself. He had proved himself a hero, and she was sure "dear old heroes had not passed away;" 5s., per William Harper, of York; 10s. from E. J. and R. J., of Leeds; 10s. from a young lady in London, who admired the driver's courage; also grapes and grapes. Miss White, matron of the hospital, desires publication to be given to the fact that a £10 note has been received by Ewart. The generous donor is unknown, and he therefore asked by this means to accept Ewart's most grateful thanks, and to feel assured that the kind message accompanying the gift is much appreciated by him. Other inquiries, assuring sympathy for the injured, and special mention is made of the brave and truly manly conduct he displayed. When the contents of the letters were made known to him, the sufferer exclaimed, "I thought I was a brave, but I only did what anybody else would do. I could not bear to hear the poor women screaming, and the wee bairns crying, for I have got eight of them myself, and I know what a condition is, all things considered, more satisfactory.

The next-of-kin of Mr Anderson, who was killed in the accident, have already received £100 from the Company, and having a copy of *Tu Bito* upon him at the time.

When the Queen's message of sympathy was conveyed to the sufferers they were very much gratified, and they have kept a copy of publication which has since been evinced in their behalf.

STATEMENTS BY EWART AND MR BUCHANAN.

Our Thirsk correspondent writes:—"On calling at the Lambert Memorial Cottage Hospital he was informed that Mr Buchanan, who had been described as a student, but who is in reality a Fellow and Tutor of St. Peter's College, Cambridge, and 4th Wrangler in the Mathematical Tripos, having taken his degree in 1888, and the driver, Ewart, were both progressing well. Mr Buchanan told the following story to his friend and fellow student in the above college, the Rev E. S. De Courcy Ireland, who was on the train at the instant visitor to the hospital since the disaster. He stated that he was asleep in the last compartment of the first carriage next to the fish waggons. He had opened his eyes at the Pleasington station and a heavy travelling rug, it being a cold morning. He remembered a crash, and was unconscious for some time. He remembered nothing further until he was in the hospital at Thirsk. He is suffering from slight wounds and injuries to the face, and his sister is in constant attendance upon him at his bedside, whilst his brother, who is staying at the Fleece Hotel in Thirsk, and who was accompanied by his father, a Nonconformist minister, is a minister of the Established Church of Scotland, from Clyde Bank, Glasgow. The driver, although improving, but very ill, is in a very weak condition. He thinks they left Newcastle, on the morning of the 2nd of November, all the way up to the scene of the collision, he experienced no sleep, which may lose some 50 minutes of his time, and when getting into straight for the Manor House cabin he saw the signal was all right, but shortly afterwards he observed through the fog the red lights of a luggage train, but so near was he upon them that it was practically too late to do anything to prevent a collision. He next felt a heavy blow on his thigh, and he remembered little more until he was picked up and conveyed to the hospital at Thirsk. The poor fellow is in excellent heart, and continues to receive the substantial sympathy of the surrounding nobility and the inhabitants of Thirsk, and from many parts of the United Kingdom, and he is every prospect, under the care of the attendant medical men, that he will slowly, but intimately, recover from the severe shock and injuries which he has received. He has been visited by the Chairman of the North-Eastern Railway Company and the various high officials from York, and the bulletins, which are regularly posted at the hospital door, continue to be eagerly scanned every morning as they are issued by the people of Thirsk.

THE FIREMAN'S STORY.

Head, the fireman of the express, was conveyed to the Northallerton Cottage Hospital, where he has received careful attention, and there has been no grounds for serious anxiety. He states that they had had a fine moonlight night up to leaving Darlington, but after passing Croft Bridge seemed to plunge suddenly into a heavy bank of fog, which continued up to the time of the accident. After they passed Northallerton the driver, Ewart, crossed over to his seat, and when the accident occurred was looking earnestly past the side of his cabin, apparently for the signal lights, which mostly lie on that side of the line. Head was in the act of replenishing the fire and had the shovel in his hand when he was suddenly struck violently into the air, and found himself on the other side of the fence. When he recovered he was lying in a field, and heard a man close at hand calling piteously for help. He went off to seek help for the poor fellow, and returning to the spot, but found he could not walk as far as the signal-cabin, and he wandered about shouting for his mate. The wreckage had not then fired, but soon after he saw it ablaze. He then came on a cottage, and after being attended by Drs Lumley and Hutchinson, was placed on a stretcher and conveyed to the Northallerton Cottage Hospital. His watch had stopped at 3.30 a.m.

A correspondent says of Head:—He is a most worthy young man, and has quite won the affections of all about. As soon as he fell to the ground, after being shot into the air at least 20 feet, he picked himself up, and after observing his companion, Ewart, and asking him how he felt, and finding he could do nothing for him, he started down the line towards Otterington to see that both trains were blocked. Being very much shaken, he was compelled by his shaken and benumbed condition to lean against a gate, being unable to move further. He eventually crawled to a house, where he was attended, and was there found by the Northallerton doctors.

THE MARQUESS OF TWEEDDALE.

The narrow escape the Marquess of Tweeddale had in the Thirsk collision was not his lordship's first experience of railway casualties. In 1886 he was a Pullman car passenger in the express which was snowed up at Morpeth, and was dug out with great difficulty. Shortly afterwards, when he was in the Pullman car Iona, a pair of the centre wheels of the car left the rails near Doncaster, and the train ran on to Gateshead, thousands of chairs and fish-bolts being cut to pieces by the wheels and the passengers having an unpleasant experience.

LETTER FROM THE CHAIRMAN OF THE COMPANY.

The matron of the Thirsk Hospital has received a letter from Mr John Dent Dent, the chairman of the North-Eastern Railway Company, in which he states:—"It was a great comfort to me to see the patients so well cared for, and in such comfortable quarters as I found them on Friday, and such institutions as your hospitals are indeed great blessings. Will you please express to the driver my great sympathy for him, and my anxiety to him about his condition, which I trust may be improving."

SYMPATHY OF RAILWAY SERVANTS.

The Newcastle No. 1 Branch of the Amalgamated Society of Railway Servants passed the following resolution on Saturday:—"That we wish to convey to Signalman Holmes our congratulation on the fact of his being a member of this society, and to express our sympathy in his sad bereavement and the unfortunate position he is placed in through the deplorable accident that has taken place at Manor House, feeling confident at the same time that England's Parliament will point of view he stands absolved from all blame."

It is rumoured that in addition to Mr Farmer Atkinson, at whose invitation the signalman Holmes has gone to London, and at whose cost the deputation of the present Parliament has offered the unfortunate man every protection and comfort in his present sad position.

THE DEATH ROLL.

The melancholy conclusion to the terrible chapter is a death roll of ten persons. Inquests have been held upon eight bodies which have been identified, and the inquiries have been adjourned. The bodies of the two unfortunate lady passengers have not been recovered, and doubtless after mutilation they were consumed by the fire.

TELEGRAPHING THE ACCIDENT.

The telegraphic officials at Thirsk, both the special and the permanent, laboured assiduously during the several days immediately following the accident in disposing of the vast mass of press and private telegrams which such a catastrophe involves, and the work was accomplished with an accuracy and celerity highly creditable to all concerned. A special telegraph staff from York, under the supervision of Mr J. Cattley, arrived on the scene in the afternoon, and getting to work without delay soon placed London, Glasgow, Edinburgh, Manchester, Leeds, and Leeds in direct communication with Thirsk.

A PROTEST FROM SIGNALMEN.

A meeting of North of England signalmen was held in Newcastle, when resolutions were passed sympathising with Holmes, and protesting against the manner in which relief was refused to men on special occasions. The present system of working signalmen's hours, it was stated, enabled them to apply to 90 per cent. of main line signalmen, was condemned, and the opinion was expressed that if the eight hours system had been in operation at Thirsk the accident would not have happened.

NEW SUNDAY SCHOOL BUILDINGS IN YORK.

On Tuesday evening, an interesting gathering took place in Layerthorpe, by invitation of the York Incorporated Sunday School Committee. This ancient society, founded towards the close of the last century, is the parent of the Church of England Sunday Schools in the city of York. Sixty years ago, upon the erection, by the Rev Joseph Willey, of day school premises in Bilton-street, the Sunday School Committee became tenants of that schoolroom on Sundays. Boys and girls were taught there together for the first fifteen years, until 1848, when the committee acquired about 1,000 yards of ground in Layerthorpe, and built a girls' schoolroom thereon; the premises in Bilton-street have from that year been used on Sundays by boys only. The generally admitted fact that Sunday schools were best and most efficiently conducted in buildings specially designed and furnished for the purpose, free from the distracting accessories of the day school, has been demonstrated by the success of the Committee's Layerthorpe girls' school and their cent. schools at Coney-street Chapel House. Encouraged by this, the Sunday School Committee have, during the present year, at considerable expense, acquired the ground and erected, in the place of their original building, a new and large schoolroom and classroom for boys. The new room measures 46ft. by 21ft., which can be divided by means of a folding partition, and the classroom is 17ft. by 14ft.; suitable cloak rooms have been provided. The building is substantial, and reflects great credit upon Mr George Kidd, of [Spen-lane, the contractor, and his sub-contractors.

The inauguration of the new premises took the form of a tea meeting for parents; invitations to which were sent by the committee to the homes of the children now in attendance at their two schools for the Layerthorpe district, with the result that about 200 of the parents assembled. A substantial tea was placed on the tables by the caterer, Mr Hobson, and the schoolroom, which was tastefully decorated, the chief features being the display of the committee's large silk banner, the device of which is an open Bible encircled by the name of the institution, and bannerettes bearing the mottoes of three of the classes, which were the leading founders of the society—namely, Alderman Stabler and Sheriffs Allanson and Saunders. After tea the guests adjourned to another part of the building, where they inspected the exhibits from the committee's Biblical Museum at Cumberland House, which were explained by Mr Gray, the museum curator, and the magnificent model of York Minster, lent by Mr Howard, also added to the interest of the exhibition. Upon returning to the large room, the Rev Canon Fausset, senior member of the committee, presided. He was supported by other members of the committee, namely, the Rev T. Smith, the Rev J. E. M. Young, Mr W. J. Clutton, J.P., the hon. treasurer, Mr W. W. Thomlinson-Walker, J.P., Mr T. Handley, Mr Muzzell, Mr Bedford, Mr John Howard, secretary; also by the superintendents of the Committee's Layerthorpe Schools, Mr Boston and Miss Robinson, and several ladies. Extracts from reports of the habitually good work received from the Rev W. H. Collins, the Rev W. Robinson, Mr B. Dent, Mr J. W. Waller, Mr H. Rowntree, and Miss L. Shann. After singing the hymn, "All hail the power of Jesus' name," the Rev. Chairman offered an appropriate dedicatory and opening prayer, and then addressed the meeting, giving a brief sketch of the history of the school, and appealing to the parents to aid the work of the teachers by their home example and influence. The Treasurer then expressed the committee's desire to secure efficient teachers, and the Secretary read a statement, by the most approved methods, and solicited the co-operation of the parents. Interspersed by the hearty singing of suitable hymns, led by the harmonium, at which Mr J. T. Hodgson presided, addresses were followed by Mr Thomlinson-Walker, Mr Muzzell, and the Secretary, each of whom narrated circumstances which had come under their own observation, either in connection with the work of the York Sunday committee's schools, or bearing on the objects desired to be attained. It was announced that the Boys' School hitherto taught in Bilton-street would from Sunday next be held in the building in Layerthorpe. Mr Boston, the boys' superintendent, and Mr Gray, on behalf of Miss Robinson, superintendent of the girls' school, urged regularity, punctuality, and other details necessary for the efficiency of the schools. The parents present were evidently deeply interested and impressed, and the proceedings were brought to a close by the Rev T. Smith pronouncing the blessing.

SWIFT "LAW."—Mr Charles Kammerer, a young American citizen, a native of Philadelphia, who some weeks ago shot himself dead when entered the house in which he was staying, near Vienna, was brought up for trial, on Wednesday, on a charge of homicide. The Court held that the circumstances proved that the occurrence was a murderous intent, and that the homicide was justifiable. He was accordingly acquitted.

REMARKABLE BREACH OF PROMISE CASE.—At Edinburgh, on Tuesday, Lord Wellwood was to have heard evidence in an action brought by Maria Fleischer against Robert Simson, and Robert Simson, a well-known resident of Edinburgh, in which pursuer sought a declaration that she was married to defendant, or for an order to be made upon him to adhere to her, or in the alternative to pay £3,000 damages. Pursuer, in her statement of the case, said she was a barmaid in Edinburgh, and in the 22nd year. The last defendant offered to marry her under certain conditions. She declined, but he wrote promising to marry her within a week if she would accept the terms. Subsequently, she wrote to defendant's answer was that he had taken too much drink on the date named, and was unconscious of what he was doing. He also said that if the letter was written it was done in a frolic. By the settlement pursuer has accepted £2,000, including expenses.

£20.—Tobacconists commencing.—See Ilid. Guide, 30. How to open respectably, £20 to £500. Tobacconist Guidings, 1d. 186, Euston-road, London.—Manager, HY. MYERS, Est. 1866. Smoke Pick Me Up Cigars, retail everywhere.

TO OVERCOME WEAKNESS.—Pepper's Quinine and Iron Tonic gives New Life, Health, Strength, and Energy.—Half-crown bottles Everywhere. Insist on having PEPPER'S.

A FAIR, BEAUTIFUL SKIN.—Sulpholine Soap gives the natural tint, and makes the skin smooth, supple, healthy, comfortable.—Ed. Tabletts. Everywhere. 388

YORK JUVENILE MISSIONARY SOCIETY.

WESLEY CIRCUIT BRANCH.

The anniversary meetings in connection with the York Wesley Circuit Branch of the above society commenced on Sunday, when sermons were preached in the Priory-street and Southlands chapels by the Revs J. Todd (Liverpool) and J. H. Hopkins (London). In continuation a lecture, entitled "England a Thousand Years Ago," was delivered in the latter place of worship on Monday evening by the Rev F. W. Macdonald, one of the general secretaries of the missionary society. Taking his remarks back to the time of Alfred the Great, and down the lecturer lucidly described the condition of the English people of that era, and also dealt with the reformatory measures passed, which had elevated the people, and the following ladies presided at the tables:—Mrs Taylor, Mrs Williams, Mrs Falconer, Mrs Shouksmith, Mrs Arnold, Mrs Turner, Mrs Mosley, Mrs Smithson, Mrs Ibbetson, Mrs R. H. Bushell, and Mrs Hill. On Tuesday afternoon a meeting was held, the Rev W. D. Williams presiding.

The CHAIRMAN expressed his regret that Mr John Francis Taylor was not able to be with them. He thought it must be many years since anything prevented his attendance on such an occasion. It was well known how earnestly and generously, and with what deep interest he had always assisted the work of Christian missions in connection with the Wesley circuit. He, however, trusted that Mr Taylor would soon resume his place amongst them. (Applause.)

Mr P. FALCONER offered a few remarks, and referred to the influence which Christianity had attained during the last fifty years.

The Rev F. W. MACDONALD, who prior to residing in York had been a missionary in India, proceeded to speak of the progress of the work in that country. They could not get to know the real results of missionary work from the mere figures contained in the reports. What was wanted in that country to-day was some great native leader; some one who would defy public opinion and bring Christianity into the hearts of the people by sentiment. He would not be surprised at any time to see a great national movement in connection with Christianity in India. There were many difficulties, and the greatest was the degradation of woman, but in concluding he quoted instances showing that the Gospel light was slowly but surely breaking upon and influencing the downtrodden condition of the women in that yet dark land. (Applause.)

The Rev C